

Amazon India launched

Junglee.in is no more, as Amazon officially launched its service in India with Amazon.in

A sneak peek at Windows 8.1

Have an up close and personal look at Windows 8.1 features, and see how it's going to be. <http://dgit.in/14z6GnL>

guide you on which lane to stay in even if you are going straight for the next 2-3kms. Navigation is precise – the nuvi 2568LM was the closest to the actual destination when it announced “you have reached your destination”, in comparison to all other navigators. Impressive set of features are carried forward as is, but in a more streamlined UI – fuel average calculator, trends to guess where you may be going and little bits like currency converter, calculator, Bluetooth for phone calls, ability to customize menu add to the overall experience. The UI is easy to navigate, thanks to a good mix of big icons and clear text. This device is compatible with the rear parking camera, and Garmin packs in lifetime map updates with the device.

MapmyIndia: While their maps look different on different devices, the navigation quality is very similar. The maps are probably the most detailed, and most devices (except the basic VX140s Premium) offer 3D Maps as well. The Zx250 still has the most exciting Aura maps – 3D landmarks, 3D buildings and even elevation changes wherever applicable. Throughout the range, the navigation precision is the same, thanks to the same set of basic maps. Voice navigation does see some variation in terms of clarity and customization options, mostly dependent on the device. The Vx140s Premium does not have 3D Maps, but the rest of the maps are the same. The Australian voice guidance is more precise when it comes to turns – can distinguish between 90 degree turns and 140 degree fork turns and guides you accordingly, whether you turn left or turn slightly left. Nice little addition that is very much appreciated. The Zx250

is also compatible with a reverse parking sensor camera, and can act as a FM transmitter and also handle mobile calls via Bluetooth and has 2GB of internal memory. But, it is good to see that the Lx340 has the 3D Maps that till now were reserved for

the trip. The amazingly clean UI is easy to navigate even for a newbie. Lots of options and settings available, but critically, all of them are the second layer, behind the maps. The fact that we don't have to tap on a map app to start the navigation is a

the MapmyIndia VX140s just by looking at the screen. Across all the tests, the Primo devices performed well above expectations, and we must compliment them for the good work.

Winners

Best Performer:

Tom Tom VIA 125

It was a very close call between the Tom Tom VIA 125 and the Garmin nuvi 2568LM. But, the VIA 125 just nicks it because of the quicker start-up time and GPS lock times, as tested. For a navigator, it is important that the device is up and ready to do its job, and not have you sit around in the car while the engine idles and the passengers become fidgety! Having said that, the nuvi 2568LM offers excellent navigation quality and the additional charging port integrated in the stand is a huge bonus.

Best Value:

Garmin nuvi 40LM

The competition in the sub-₹10k price bracket was between the nuvi 40LM and the Primo GPS PG411G, and the 40LM won because of the slightly better performance figures. With the MapmyIndia maps on board, Primo's navigators are much improved over last year. But one thing that we are a bit sceptical about is the map update frequency and schedule, because of the third-party mapping.

Editor's Pick:

MapmyIndia Lx340

There really was no competition, because the Lx340 brings a lot of good stuff to the table in one package – affordability, steady performance and 3D Maps in a lower priced offering. This is one GPS device that has the navigation experience and quality of a higher end product. 



TomTom VIA 125

more expensive devices only. For a device that costs less than ₹10k, that is indeed great value.

TomTom VIA: We just love these TomTom devices, and while their maps aren't 3D, they still look gorgeous and good to use. They are the most matter-of-fact navigators of the entire bunch. Each VIA series navigator just goes about doing what it is supposed to do, in a very precise fashion. German precision almost! Switch on any of the VIA devices, and it opens up straight on the Maps application. And just like that, you are good to go. Extremely quick GPS lock times help in that motive as well. Navigation quality is at par with what Garmin offers. But, there were a couple of instances on our test runs when the maps got a bit confused, and had to re-lock the GPS signal and recalculate

huge bonus. Voice direction is at par with MapMyIndia devices, which is a huge positive. The display changes orientation very smoothly, depending on how you have placed the device, something that most other devices don't do. Next step for TomTom devices would be to sport 3D Maps on board, even if only for the visual element.

Primo GPS: The best thing that Primo GPS could have done for their navigation devices was to shift away from SatGuide maps, and that is exactly what they did. The switch to MapmyIndia maps puts the navigation quality at par with the other devices. The positive impact on the overall usability and experience is telling. Essentially, once mounted on the windshield and in navigation mode, you cannot really tell the difference between the Primo devices and